



national team is all set to begin with the Sultan Johor Cup, starting on October 19 in Malaysia.

Sreejesh has also opted out of the upcoming Hockey India League player auctions, instead taking up the role of Director and mentor of the Delhi SG Pipers in the tournament. But amid all the shifts in his career, one thing remains certain: his connection to home.

"I don't think we can move from Kizhakkambalam. Even if I'm willing, I don't think my parents could. I can

Ubiquitous icon: Kizhakkambalam stands out as probably the only place in Kerala where P.R. Sreejesh, the state's only double Olympic medallist, has more flex boards than Lionel Messi and the Argentinian football team. THULASI KAKKAT

live anywhere, but there's a sense of belonging here. The people are cooperative in a way you don't find in cities or flats. **I'm away from all the disturbances when I'm here. It's a different feeling,**" says Sreejesh.

As the interview wrapped up, Sreejesh picked up his heavier-than-they-look Olympic

medals and posed for photos in his front yard. It's a choreography he has mastered over time.

The medals, once again, will return to their place on the coffee table, waiting for that one-in-a-hundred visitor Sreejesh hopes will be inspired to carry his legacy forward.